



Phishing **Awareness Training**

–Ram Gangul

Your Essential Guide to Recognizing Attacks &
Staying Safe Online

Get Started

What is Phishing?

Phishing is a type of cyber attack where criminals impersonate trusted entities — such as banks, companies, or colleagues — to trick individuals into revealing sensitive information like passwords, credit card numbers, or personal data.

It is the **#1** cyber security threat worldwide, responsible for over 90% of data breaches. Attackers use deceptive emails, fake websites, and social engineering to exploit human trust rather than technical vulnerabilities.



Thynk Unlimited

How to Recognize Phishing Emails



Suspicious Sender

Emails from unknown or misspelled domains (e.g., support@paypa1.com) are red flags. Always verify the sender's full email address carefully.

Urgent Language

Phishing emails use urgency like "Act now!" or "Your account will be closed!" to pressure you into clicking links without thinking.

Spelling & Grammar Errors

Poor grammar, odd phrasing, and typos are common signs of phishing. Professional organizations send well-written, polished communications.

Suspicious Links

Hover over links before clicking. Phishing URLs often mimic real sites with subtle changes like extra characters or wrong domain endings.

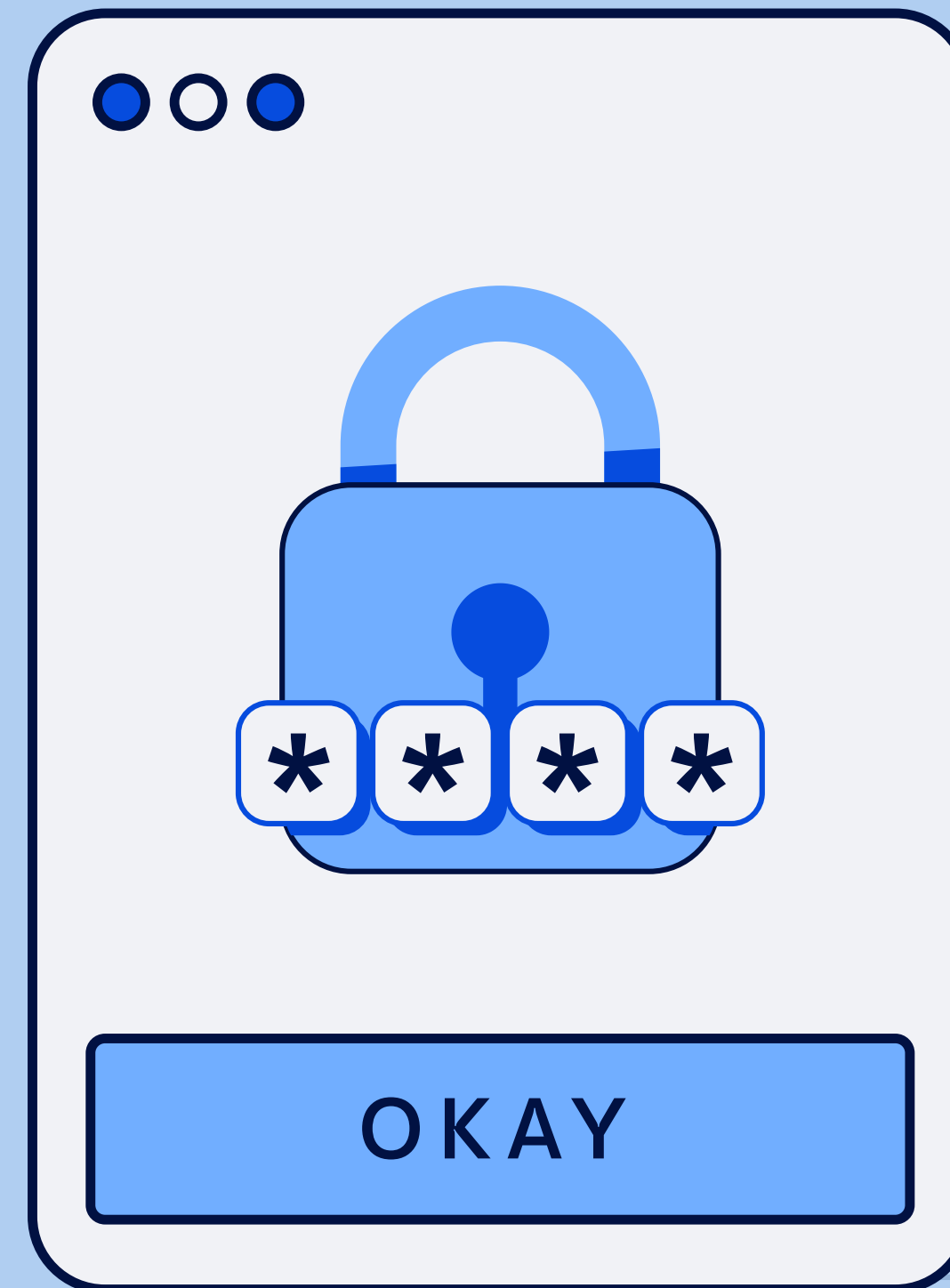
Requests for Personal Info

Legitimate companies rarely ask for passwords, SSNs, or credit card numbers via email. Never share sensitive data through email links.

Spotting Fake Websites

Check the URL carefully for misspellings or extra characters. Always look for HTTPS and a padlock icon in the browser bar. Verify the domain name matches the official site exactly.

Watch for poor design, broken layouts, or low-quality images. Never click links directly from emails — type the URL manually. When in doubt, close the page and contact the organization directly.



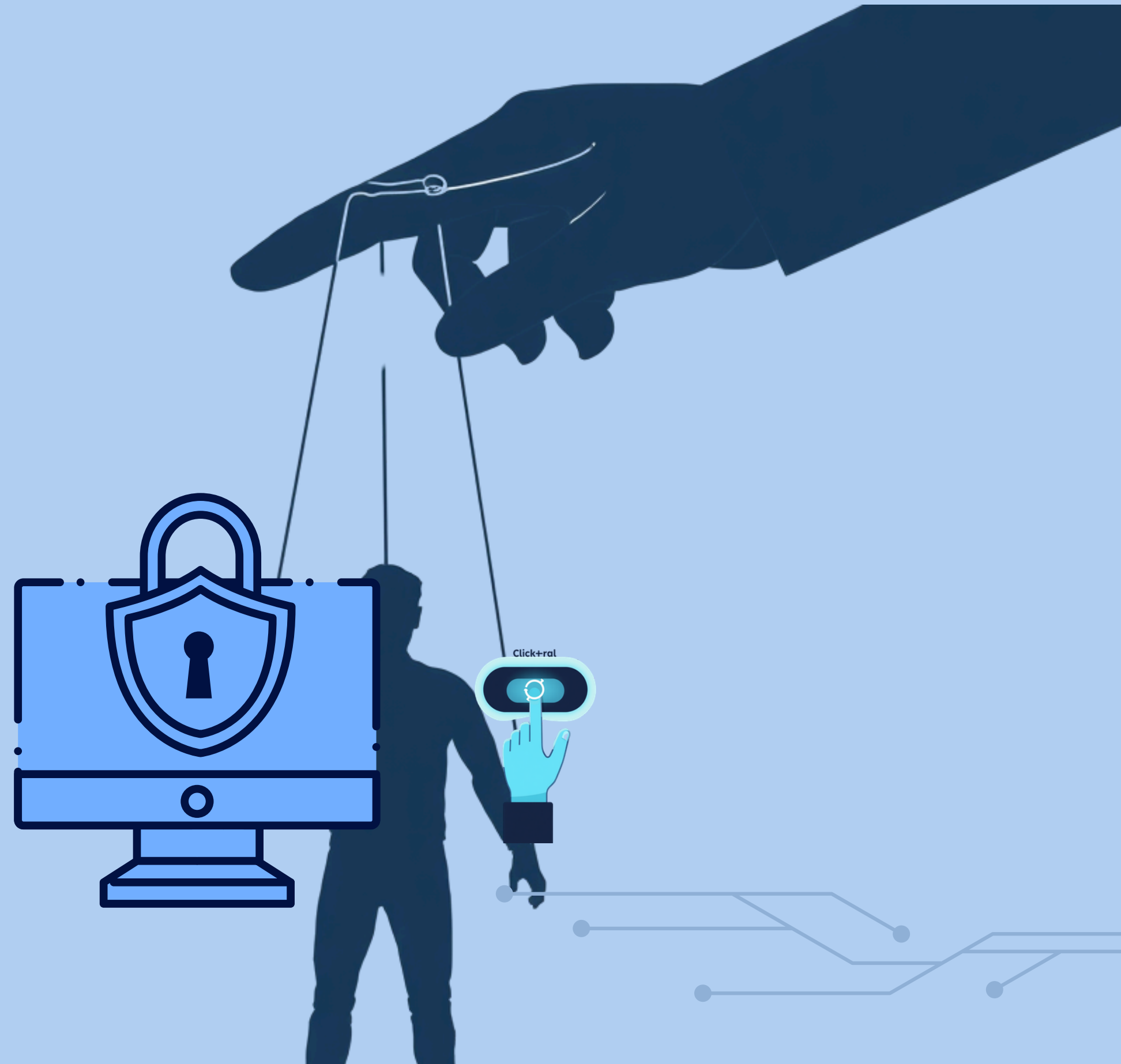
Social Engineering Tactics Used by Attackers



Pretexting: Attackers create a fabricated scenario (e.g., posing as IT support or a bank) to trick victims into revealing sensitive information or granting access.

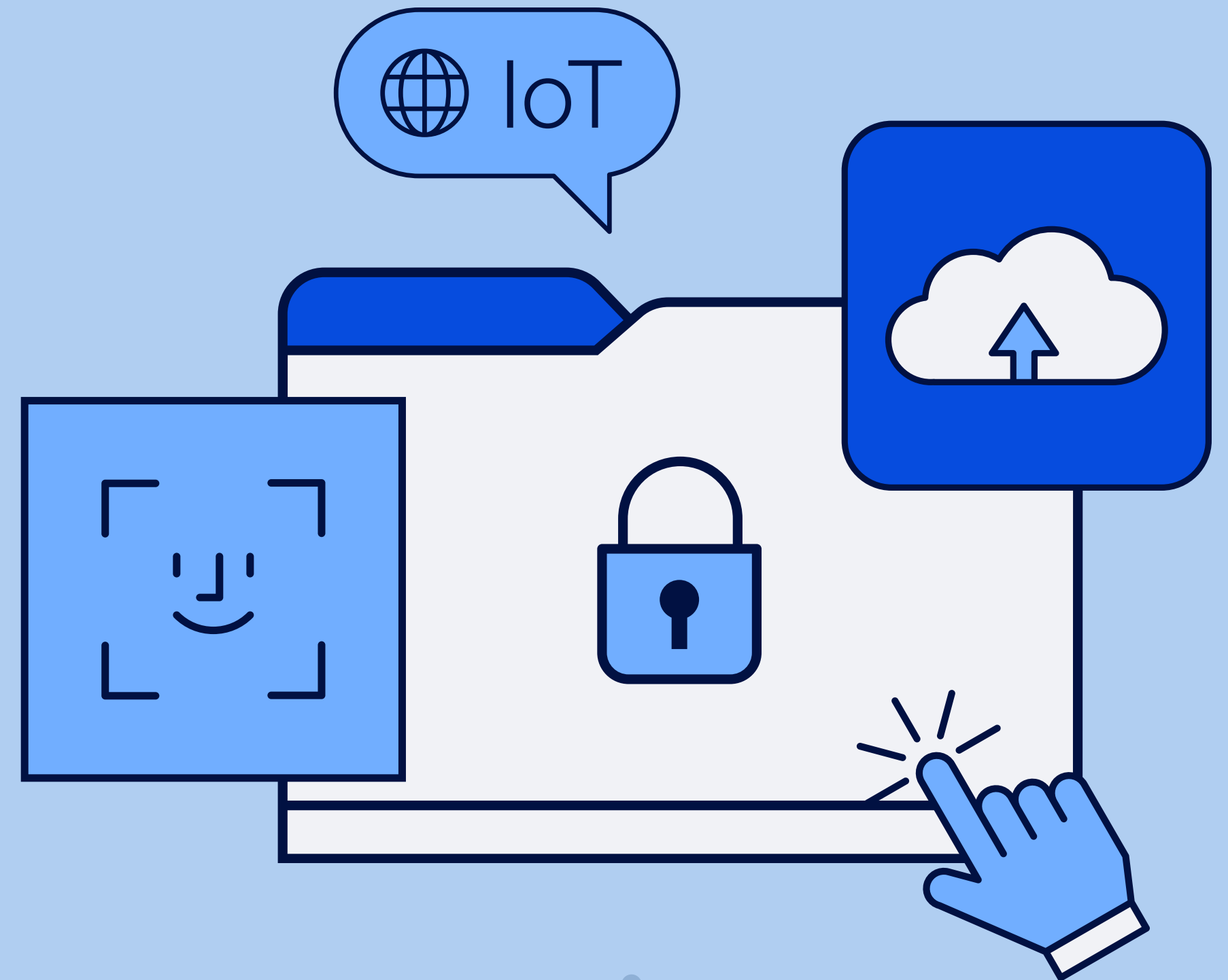


Baiting: Attackers lure victims with something enticing — like a free download or USB drive — that secretly delivers malware or harvests credentials.



Best Practices to Avoid Phishing

- ✓ Verify the sender's email address carefully before responding or clicking any links. Look for subtle misspellings or unusual domains that mimic legitimate organizations.
- ✓ Hover over links before clicking to preview the URL. Enable multi-factor authentication (MFA), report suspicious emails to IT, and keep your software and antivirus updated at all times.



Real-World **Phishing Examples**

Fake Invoice Scam: Employees at a mid-size firm received emails mimicking a trusted vendor, requesting urgent payment to a new account. The spoofed domain looked nearly identical, and thousands were transferred before fraud was detected.

CEO Fraud: Staff received emails appearing to be from their CEO requesting a wire transfer. The attacker used a lookalike domain and urgent language. Always verify financial requests through a secondary channel before acting.



Test Your **Knowledge!**



- 1. The sender's address looks slightly misspelled. Is it safe? Answer: No, small changes often signal a fake sender.**
- 2. An email claims your account will be closed in one hour unless you click a link. What does this mean? Answer: It's a pressure tactic often used in scams.**
- 3. A message asks you to download an attachment you weren't expecting. What now? Answer: Avoid opening it; unexpected files can contain harmful software.**

Your Next Steps

Remember the warning signs: check sender addresses, hover over links before clicking, and never share passwords or personal data via email. Report any suspicious emails or messages to your IT security team immediately.

Complete the phishing awareness quiz to test your knowledge, then share these best practices with your colleagues. Together, a vigilant team is your organization's strongest defense against phishing attacks.



**Thank You for
Completing the Training!**

